

STANDARD CHARTERED (STAN.L/2888.HK)

Q2'26 preview

We update our estimates for STAN ahead of its Q2'26 results on the 29th July. We note the following:

For Q2'26E, we model net profit (post-AT1) of c.\$1.6bn for the Group (5% ahead of Visible Alpha Consensus Data). More broadly, across FY26-28E, we are 2%/2%/4% ahead of consensus on earnings, driven primarily by our more constructive view on both fee income and NII growth, driving a GSe statutory ROTE of 13.6% for 2026E (vs guidance of >12%), building to 16.3% by 2028E (vs guidance of >15%), while our 18.0% ROTE in 2030 is in line with the c.18% target.

Income: In terms of statutory operating income, we model c.\$5.6bn for Q2'26E (+2% y/y), including robust growth in CIB revenues (+4% y/y), given a supportive backdrop, with management having highlighted at our European Financials Conference (3rd June) the continued origination momentum within Global Banking following the strong Q1 print, alongside solid Flow momentum, while flagging a challenging y/y comp for Episodic income. Our NII estimate of c.\$2.9bn for the quarter is 2% ahead of consensus, reflecting a modest sequential uptick q/q, in part driven by the uptick in HIBOR levels throughout the quarter and the day-count impact of an additional day in Q2 — across FY26E, we model c.\$11.5bn (+3% y/y, 1% ahead of consensus, and ahead of guidance of a broadly flat NII inclusive of the expected c.2% headwind from WRB portfolio actions). Given the growth in both NII and fee income, this leaves our statutory income growth at +6.5% for FY26E, also ahead of guidance of the lower end of a 5-7% range at constant currency.

Costs and asset quality: We forecast statutory operating expenses of c.\$3.3bn for Q2'26E (in line with consensus), while we model +0.5% expense growth y/y across FY26E (vs guidance from broadly flat growth, inclusive of the final year of Fit For Growth programme with c.\$0.6bn in associated charges). Looking ahead, our expense forecasts are c.1% ahead of consensus across 2026-28E, as we reflect inflation and business growth expectations — alongside our income estimates, we model a CIR of 60%/57%/55% across 2026/27/28E (vs STAN's guidance for a c.57% CIR by 2028, excluding notable items). Turning to asset quality, we reduce our credit cost estimates, including a c.\$220mn print at Q2'26E (11% below consensus), and then full-year CoR at 32bp/31bp/32bp (1-3bp lower than consensus, and vs STAN's through-the-cycle guidance range of 30-35bp). At our recent conference, management noted that, while remaining cognisant of the more uncertain macro

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backdrop, asset quality trends remain comforting and highlighted further anticipated de-risking benefits from various parts of the current plan (such as the WRB focus on the Affluent segment, and the CIB focus on larger corporates).

Capital: At Q2 results, we expect STAN to announce a c.\$1bn SBB, taking the FY26E SBB distribution to c.\$2.5bn (down 11% y/y vs 2025 levels, reflecting STAN's capital reallocation plans, as laid out during the Investor Event in May, shifting away from the historical SBB skew towards a more even split between organic growth, dividends, and SBBs). Following the outsized RWA growth seen at Q1 (+3% q/q), we model a more normalised rate in upcoming quarters (0-1% q/q), and looking ahead we forecast a +4.5% RWA CAGR across 2025-28E (with STAN having noted that RWAs are set to grow at a lower rate vs the 5-7% income CAGR guidance, given the focus on capital productivity within the current plan). For Q2'26E, we model a 13.9% CET1 ratio (broadly in line with consensus), with our year-end estimates at 13.6%/13.7%/14.0% (c.20bp lower than consensus, in part reflecting c.1% higher RWA), remaining within the upper end of the 13-14% target range.

Estimate changes and valuation: Our EPS forecasts change modestly across 2026/27/28E (-0%/-1%/+1%), as we slightly increase our NII and fee income estimates across each year, and reduce our credit costs, while we also increase our operating expense forecasts, and reflect a higher share price assumption in our SBB assumptions. For STAN.L, we use a P/E methodology, and we now increase our target multiple to 11.5x (previously 10.25x), to reflect our increased confidence in management's execution of the current strategic plan to deliver a c.18% ROTE by 2030E, applied 75%/25% to our 2027/28E estimates, to arrive at a 12m price target of 2,530p (previously 2,260p) — similarly, for 2888.HK, we revise our 12m two-stage DDM based price target up to HK\$267 (previously HK\$242), with our new price targets for each ticker reflecting c.20% upside to the latest respective share prices. We remain Buy rated. Downside risks include reversal/pause of positive jaws delivery, slower-than-expected non-interest income growth, lower-than-expected net interest income growth.

Exhibit 1: GSe vs Visible Alpha Consensus Data

STAN	2Q26E				2026E				2027E				2028E			
	GS	VA	%	mn	GS	VA	%	mn	GS	VA	%	mn	GS	VA	%	mn
Net Interest Income	2,892	2,836	2%	56	11,503	11,358	1%	145	11,852	11,685	1%	168	12,470	12,099	3%	371
Non-NII	2,750	2,738	0%	12	10,807	10,859	0%	-52	12,082	11,902	2%	180	13,223	12,998	2%	225
Revenues	5,642	5,574	1%	68	22,310	22,217	0%	94	23,934	23,587	1%	347	25,693	25,097	2%	596
Statutory Operating Expenses	-3,249	-3,241	0%	-8	-13,367	-13,275	1%	-91	-13,610	-13,421	1%	-189	-14,156	-13,964	1%	-192
PPP	2,392	2,333	3%	60	8,944	8,942	0%	2	10,324	10,166	2%	158	11,537	11,133	4%	404
Credit Costs	-218	-246	-11%	28	-956	-979	-2%	23	-960	-1,025	-6%	65	-1,048	-1,057	-1%	9
Other Impairments	-12	-13	-8%	1	-38	-43	-12%	5	-48	-55	-13%	7	-48	-59	-18%	11
Associates and JV	47	44	6%	3	6	37	-84%	-31	13	47	-72%	-34	14	63	-78%	-49
PBT	2,209	2,118	4%	91	7,956	7,957	0%	-1	9,329	9,133	2%	196	10,455	10,080	4%	374
Income Taxes	-619	-578	7%	-41	-2,082	-2,158	-4%	77	-2,612	-2,510	4%	-102	-2,927	-2,747	7%	-180
PAT	1,591	1,540	3%	50	5,874	5,799	1%	76	6,717	6,622	1%	95	7,527	7,333	3%	194
Minorities	-5	-4	35%	-1	-25	-19	35%	-6	-20	-23	-11%	3	-20	-28	-28%	8
Net income pre-AT1s	1,586	1,537	3%	49	5,849	5,780	1%	69	6,697	6,600	1%	97	7,507	7,305	3%	202
Preferred Stock	-11	-37	-70%	26	-534	-575	-7%	41	-534	-583	-8%	49	-534	-586	-9%	52
Net income post-AT1s	1,575	1,500	5%	75	5,315	5,205	2%	110	6,163	6,017	2%	146	6,973	6,720	4%	253
Per Share Data																
EPS - Basic	0.71	0.67	6%	0.04	2.42	2.30	5%	0.12	2.92	2.80	4%	0.12	3.43	3.22	6%	0.20
DPS - Declared	0.20	0.19	4%	0.01	0.82	0.72	14%	0.10	0.99	0.85	17%	0.14	1.16	0.97	20%	0.19
Capital																
CET1 Capital (bn)	37	37	0%	0	37	37	-1%	0	39	39	-1%	0	41	41	0%	0
RWAs (bn)	266	268	0%	-1	270	268	1%	2	281	279	1%	2	294	291	1%	3
CET1 Ratio	13.9%	13.8%	10bp	-	13.6%	13.8%	(18bp)	-	13.7%	14.0%	(21bp)	-	14.0%	14.1%	(18bp)	-
Balance Sheet (bn)																
Total Assets	985	967	2%	-	1,003	959	5%	-	1,036	986	5%	-	1,068	1,015	5%	-
Total Equity	55	55	-1%	-	55	55	0%	-	57	57	0%	-	60	59	1%	-
Tangible Equity	39	39	1%	-	39	39	0%	-	42	41	1%	-	44	43	2%	-
Loans	296	296	0%	-	303	299	1%	-	320	311	3%	-	336	323	4%	-
Deposits	554	548	1%	-	572	558	2%	-	602	581	4%	-	632	604	5%	-
Ratios																
Net-Interest Margin				-	3.90%	3.87%	0.0	-	3.80%	3.83%	0.0	-	3.80%	3.82%	0.0	-
CIR	58%	58%	-1	-	60%	60%	0.2	-	57%	57%	0.0	-	55%	56%	-0.5	-
Cost of Risk				-	32	33	-1.0	-	31	34	-2.8	-	32	33	-1.4	-
Effective Tax Rate	28%	27%	1	-	26.2%	27.1%	-1.0	-	28.0%	27.5%	0.5	-	28.0%	27.3%	0.7	-
ROTE (post AT1)				-	13.6%	13.3%	0.3	-	15.2%	14.9%	0.3	-	16.3%	15.9%	0.4	-
Loans / Deposits	53%	54%	-1	-	53%	54%	-0.6	-	53%	54%	-0.4	-	53%	53%	-0.3	-

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, Visible Alpha Consensus Data

STAN.L		12m Price Target: 2530p	Price: 2100p	Upside: 20.5%		
Buy		GS Forecast				
			12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Market cap: £46.8bn / \$62.6bn		Net inc. (\$ mn) New	4,558.0	5,315.4	6,162.7	6,973.3
3m ADTV :£141.3mn/ \$189.6mn		Net inc. (\$ mn) Old	4,558.0	5,296.3	6,214.0	6,855.3
United Kingdom		EPS (\$ New)	1.89	2.34	2.83	3.32
Europe Banks		EPS (\$ Old)	1.89	2.34	2.87	3.30
		EPS growth (%)	36.2	23.9	20.5	17.4
M&A Rank: 3		P/E (X)	9.1	12.0	9.9	8.5
		P/B (X)	0.9	1.3	1.2	1.1
		Price/PPOP (X)	8.2	7.0	6.1	5.4
		Dividend yield (%)	3.5	2.9	3.5	4.1
			3/26	6/26E	9/26E	12/26E
		EPS (\$)	0.72	0.69	0.59	0.34

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 13 Jul 2026 close.

2888.HK	12m Price Target: HK\$267	Price: HK\$220	Upside: 21.4%			
Buy	GS Forecast					
		12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E	
	Market cap: HK\$490.4bn / \$62.6bn	Net inc. (\$ mn) New	4,558.0	5,315.4	6,162.7	6,973.3
	3m ADTV :HK\$219.8mn/ \$28.0mn	Net inc. (\$ mn) Old	4,558.0	5,296.3	6,214.0	6,855.3
	Hong Kong	EPS (HK\$) New	14.72	18.24	21.99	25.80
	Asia Financials	EPS (HK\$) Old	14.72	18.22	22.31	25.70
		EPS growth (%)	36.3	23.4	20.3	17.4
	M&A Rank: 3	P/E (X)	9.1	12.0	10.0	8.5
		P/B (X)	0.9	1.3	1.2	1.1
		Price/PPOP (X)	8.2	7.0	6.1	5.4
		Dividend yield (%)	3.5	2.9	3.5	4.1
			3/26	6/26E	9/26E	12/26E
		EPS (HK\$)	5.60	5.38	4.56	2.67

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 14 Jul 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

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We, Chris Hallam, Melissa Kuang, CFA, Benjamin Caven-Roberts, Sachin Nayar and Wayne Wang, hereby certify that all of the views expressed in this report accurately reflect our personal views about the subject company or companies and its or their securities. We also certify that no part of our compensation was, is or will be, directly or indirectly, related to the specific recommendations or views expressed in this report.

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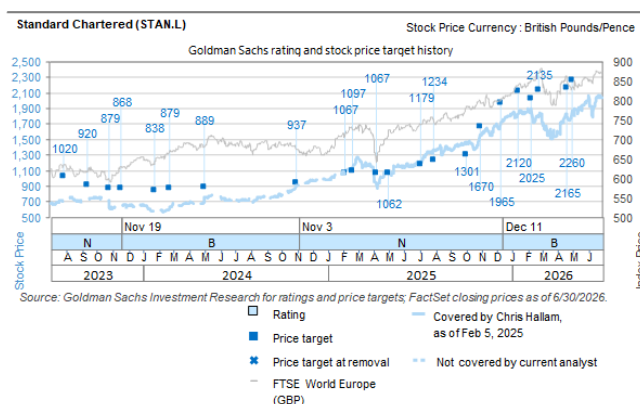
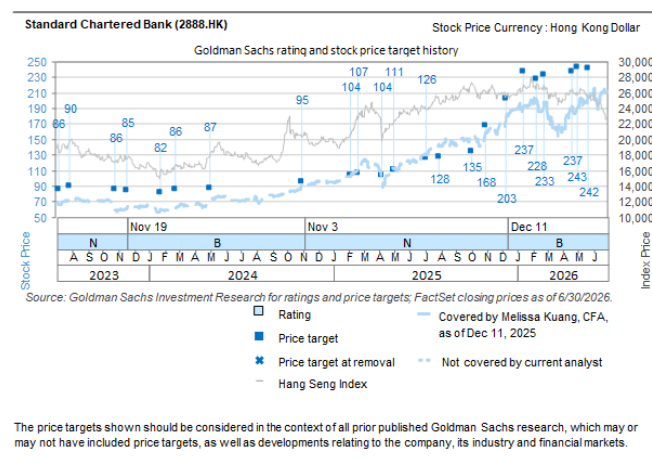
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Price target and rating history chart(s)



Target price history table(s)

Standard Chartered Bank (2888.HK)

Date of report	Target price (HK\$)	Closing price (HK\$)
22-May-26	242.00	204.00
30-Apr-26	243.00	190.80
21-Apr-26	237.00	192.40
24-Feb-26	233.00	197.90
09-Feb-26	228.00	202.00
13-Jan-26	237.00	191.60
11-Dec-25	203.00	177.00
30-Oct-25	168.00	159.50
03-Oct-25	135.00	152.60
31-Jul-25	128.00	142.00
04-Jul-25	126.00	130.30
02-May-25	111.00	113.60
07-Apr-25	104.00	91.50
21-Feb-25	107.00	116.00
05-Feb-25	104.00	103.60
30-Oct-24	95.00	90.75
02-May-24	87.00	71.95
23-Feb-24	86.00	62.45
23-Jan-24	82.00	58.00
19-Nov-23	85.00	61.30
26-Oct-23	86.00	59.75
28-Jul-23	90.00	74.50

Standard Chartered (STAN.L)

Date of report	Target price (£)	Closing price (£)
30-Apr-26	2,260	1,862.8
21-Apr-26	2,165	1,806
24-Feb-26	2,135	1,789
09-Feb-26	2,025	1,899
13-Jan-26	2,120	1,832
11-Dec-25	1,965	1,717
30-Oct-25	1,670	1,571
03-Oct-25	1,301	1,467
31-Jul-25	1,234	1,360.5
04-Jul-25	1,179	1,207
02-May-25	1,062	1,096.5
07-Apr-25	1,067	937.2
21-Feb-25	1,097	1,183
05-Feb-25	1,067	1,074
30-Oct-24	937	912.6
02-May-24	889	756
23-Feb-24	879	635
23-Jan-24	838	605.8
19-Nov-23	868	660
26-Oct-23	879	625.2
12-Sep-23	920	725.4
28-Jul-23	1,020	737.6

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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